Maxwell asserts that Henry McMahon was transferred out of India after the Shimla conference with the implication that it was because of what he had ‘done’ in 1914.[37] In fact, McMahon, who spoke not only Hindustani and Persian but also Arabic, was awarded the post of High Commissioner for Egypt in 1915. This was hardly a punishment or even a demotion. From his base in Cairo, McMahon helped organize Arab leaders against the Ottoman Empire, which became a success when they rose up to fight for independence in 1916–17.

Maxwell also writes that, ‘nothing more was done, or indeed heard, about the “McMahon Line” until 1935, when an official in Delhi, Olaf Caroe, happened upon the agreement with the Tibetans in old files and began to agitate within the government for making the Line the effective north-east boundary of India’.[38]

Caroe, also according to Maxwell, ‘succeeded, with difficulty, in getting it [the McMahon Line] on to some official maps; and he arranged for the falsification of the published record of the Simla Conference of 1914 in *Aitchison’s Treaties* so as to make it appear that there had been agreement there among all parties on the new “McMahon” alignment”’. It was only then, Maxwell asserts, that ‘the British in India began slowly to move their administration forward, up towards the crest along which McMahon had drawn his line’.[39]

Lamb is more thorough and scholarly in his approach to the boundary issue than Maxwell, but he also blames Caroe for ‘falsifying’ documents and changing the border on his own accord. It was not easy for Caroe, Lamb states, ‘to convince politicians that there really was a serious situation involving the security of territory which was technically British but about which the rulers of the British Empire had somehow managed to forget for more than two decades. If it was so important, how was it that it had slipped the official memory?’[40]

However, other scholars disagree with Lamb, and his interpretation of events is weak and debatable, to say the least. It is undeniable that a border agreement was indeed reached between the British and the Tibetans at Shimla, as documented by Leo E. Rose, a professor at Berkeley, and many others. And apart from criticizing Lamb for espousing overly pro-Chinese views, Rose also points at several more precise weaknesses in the British academic’s writings on the McMahon Line. Rose takes Lamb to task on